

A curve has equation $y = f(x)$ where

$$f(x) = x^2 - 5x + e^x \quad x \in \mathbb{R}$$

(a) Show that the equation $f(x) = 0$ has a root, α , in the interval $[1, 2]$

(2)

The iterative formula

$$x_{n+1} = \sqrt{5x_n - e^{x_n}}$$

with $x_1 = 1$ is used to find an approximate value for the root α .

(b) (i) Find the value of x_2 to 4 decimal places.

(ii) Find, by repeated iteration, the value of α , giving your answer to 4 decimal places.

(3)